

SINHAGAD FORT

Complete Trekking Itinerary

📍• Sinhagad Fort

Pune, Maharashtra • Pune (30 km)

Sinhagad Fort is a historic hill fortress located 30 km southwest of Pune. Famous for the Battle of Sinhagad in 1670, where Tanaji Malusare sacrificed his life to capture it from the Mughals. The fort offers panoramic views, easy trekking routes, and authentic Maharashtrian food.

Quick Facts

- Distance: 4 km trek from Donje Village
- Duration: 1.5-2 hours (one way)
- Altitude: 1,312 meters (600m elevation gain)

🗺️ TREKKING ROUTES

1. Donje Village Route

Distance: 4 km | Duration: 1.5-2 hours

Difficulty: Easy | Elevation: 600 meters gain (700m to 1312m)

Well-maintained stone steps from Donje village to fort top. Most popular and easiest route suitable for beginners and families. 400 steps with railings.

Facilities: 5 rest points with benches, Tea stalls at 3 points, Water available, Mobile network coverage

2. Ghorawadi Village Route

Distance: 5 km | Duration: 3 hours

Difficulty: Difficult | Elevation: 700 meters gain

Steeper and more rugged route. Less crowded, more scenic. Rocky terrain suitable for experienced trekkers.

Facilities: Fewer rest points, Limited vendors, More challenging climb

3. Motorable Road

Distance: Direct vehicle access | Duration: 15 minutes drive

Difficulty: Easy | Elevation: No trekking required

Vehicles can go up to parking area near fort. Shared jeeps available for ₹120

Facilities: Parking available, Shared jeeps, No trekking needed

🏰 MUST-SEE LANDMARKS

1. Tanaji Malusare Memorial (Memorial)

Memorial dedicated to Tanaji Malusare, the Maratha warrior who sacrificed his life capturing this fort in 1670. Features statue and historical inscriptions.

Historical Significance: Site commemorating the famous Battle of Sinhagad and Tanaji's sacrifice - 'Gad ala, pan Sinha gela' (Fort captured, but the lion is gone)

Time: 20-30 minutes

2. Kaundinyeshwar Temple (Temple)

Ancient Shiva temple with traditional stone architecture. Peaceful atmosphere with priest sharing historical stories.

Historical Significance: Temple visited by Shivaji Maharaj. Important religious site on the fort.

Time: 15-20 minutes

3. Rajaram's Tomb (Memorial)

Tomb of Chhatrapati Rajaram Maharaj (son of Shivaji Maharaj). Maratha-era architecture with dome structure.

Historical Significance: Final resting place of Rajaram Maharaj who ruled after Shivaji

Time: 15 minutes

4. Kalyan Darwaja (Gate)

Eastern gate of the fort with steep approach. Strategic entrance with excellent views. Requires careful climbing.

Historical Significance: One of the main defensive gates of the fort

Time: 20 minutes

5. Pune Darwaja (Gate)

Main entrance gate facing Pune city. First landmark visitors see when arriving at fort top.

Historical Significance: Primary entrance to the fort, well-preserved structure

Time: 10 minutes

6. Fort Walls and Ramparts (Fortification)

Extensive fort walls offering 360-degree panoramic views of Pune city, Khadakwasla Dam, and surrounding Sahyadri mountains. Best photography spot.

Historical Significance: Original Maratha-era fortifications

Time: 30-45 minutes

🍽️ MUST-TRY FOOD

1. Pithla Bhakri (180-120)

Gram flour curry served with thick millet bread. Authentic Maharashtrian village food. Served with raw onions and green chili.

Available at: Multiple stalls on fort top, Hotel Kondaji

2. Kanda Bhaji (₹140-60)

Crispy onion fritters (pakoras). Best enjoyed hot with cutting chai.

Available at: Tea stalls throughout fort

3. Zunka Bhakar (₹70-100)

Dry gram flour preparation with bhakri bread. Spicy and filling.

Available at: Local food stalls

4. Fresh Dahi (Yogurt) (₹30-50)

Homemade yogurt served in earthen pots. Incredibly creamy and fresh.

Available at: Local women vendors

5. Cutting Chai (₹10-15)

Half cup of strong, sweet tea. Perfect with bhaji.

Available at: All tea stalls

👉“... BEST TIME TO VISIT

Recommended: Monsoon (June-September), Winter (November-February)

Avoid: Summer afternoons (March-May), Heavy rain days

& p SAFETY TIPS

1. Steep sections near Kalyan Darwaja - use railings carefully
2. Paths can be slippery during monsoon - wear proper footwear with grip
3. Fort walls don't have railings everywhere - be careful near edges, especially with kids
4. Leeches possible during monsoon - carry salt
5. Start descent by 4:30 PM to avoid darkness on trail

👉° BUDGET ESTIMATE (Per Person)

- Transport from Pune: ₹200-300
- Food on fort: ₹150-250
- Miscellaneous: ₹100-150
- **Total: ₹450-700**